

Rise of the Drones

Everything is getting smarter day by day, drones don't want to be left out of the bandwagon. So here they come.
<http://dgit.in/Smartflier>



Nuke them up!

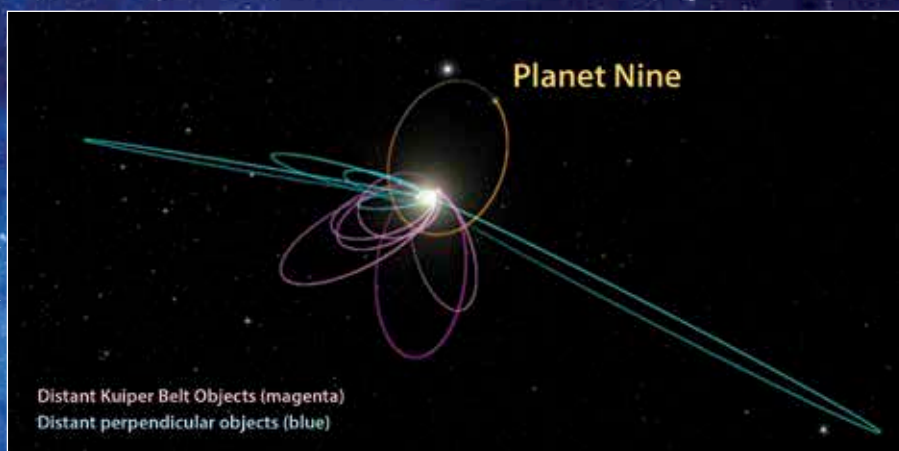
Russia plans to use nukes if it finds any asteroid heading towards earth, so sleep soundly.
<http://dgit.in/NukeThem>

Space Age

WILL BROWN AND BATYGIN'S CALCULATIONS HOLD TRUE, OR IS THIS YET ANOTHER INSTANCE OF SCIENTISTS BEING OVERENTHUSIASTIC?

The quest for Planet X has been prevalent, with Neptune's discovery being followed by Pluto's, and subsequently, discovery of similar-sized planets that happen to be a frequent occurrence in the Kuiper's Belt. Have we already explored the horizon, or does our Solar System really hold another massive planet?

Last month, a series of telescope dishes collectively called the Atacama Large Millimeter Array (ALMA) gave researchers what was believed to be a faint microwave glow of a rocky planet that was 300 AU away. At a distance of almost twice as far as Earth and Pluto are, did they really catch a faint sight of Planet X? Possibly not, seeing that Brown and Batygin's hypothesis points at all logical corners referring it to be a gaseous body. Nevertheless, Brown had previously disregarded it, saying that the ALMA had too narrow a field of view, to be able to distinctly and conclusively finding an object so far out in space.



Planet 9's highly elliptical path stands out from the rest



Kuiper Belt - where planets mysteriously appear from

orbit. Additionally, it spins in a direction away from the rest of the planets. While the eight solar system residents revolve around the Sun, only a point of Planet X's elliptical orbit comes near the Sun.

The evidence has not been spotted, and scientists predict that it may take as long as 5 to 15 years, until Planet X becomes visible. Owing to its massive, irregular orbit, the planet's perihelion (its

closest point to the sun) is at the aphe-
lion (the farthest point from the sun) of the other six dwarfs. The elliptical orbit is set up in a completely different angle, away from the set of eight planets, and the group of plutoids, taking up to 20,000 years to orbit the sun. It spends most of its time at around 600 to 1200 AU away from the Sun. It interacts with the six plutoids once every about 50,000 years, and these dwarf planets do cross its orbit. However, that does not occur when the planet is near enough to disrupt the gravitational location of any of these planets. As proof, the scientists calculated the mean position of the dwarf planets, pointed the telescopes at them, and they were right about it. This led to further confirmation of Brown and Batygin's calculations that the giant may indeed be out there, lurking out of sight, possibly offended by being ignored for so long.

The scientists have stated a 0.007% chance, or one in 15,000 chances, for the clustering of the six planets to be coincidental, given the gravitational interaction at play out there. If the scientists do manage to catch sight of the long-lost giant that they are claiming to have found, this may have much wider impact on astronomy. For one, this will be the first "large" planet which will have an orbit that travels into the solar system, and heads wide out of the Kuiper Belt.

The scientists are out to welcome back one of our own, not counting the dwarf planets, or 'plutoids', as named since Pluto was demoted to the status of a dwarf planet in 2006. Incidentally, it was Prof. Brown who passed the judgement on dwarf planets, leading to the unceremonious relegation of Pluto. Will the man who once killed the emotions of a tiny planet bring a long-lost giant back home?